JAMES WHITNEY

Data Scientist

Email: james.whitney@gmail.com

Phone: +44 7891 234567

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jameswhitney92

GitHub: github.com/jwhitney-ds

REPOSITORIES:

- sentiment-analysis-toolkit (Python NLP project with 245 stars)
- neural-network-from-scratch (Educational implementation in NumPy)
- real-time-anomaly-detector (Kafka streaming anomaly detection)
- time-series-forecasting-suite (LSTM and statistical methods comparison)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a data scientist with nearly four years in the field, though my career trajectory has been unusual. I started as a junior developer, somehow found myself leading a team of 23 engineers after just eighteen months, and then moved back into individual contributor data science work because I realised I actually prefer building models to managing people. I've worked across manufacturing, healthcare data platforms, and logistics optimisation. I'm strongest with Python, scikit-learn, and anything involving predictive modelling, though my experience jumping between different roles has left me with an oddly wide but somewhat shallow skill set.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Machine Learning Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd (Previously known as Quantum Analytics Group)

Birmingham, United Kingdom

August 2023 - Present

Synapse Data Ltd website: synapsedataltd.io

Led the complete overhaul of the model serving architecture, reducing inference latency by 67% through containerisation and model quantisation techniques

Directed strategic initiatives for the machine learning platform serving 14 different business units across the organisation, managing stakeholder expectations and delivery timelines

Architected end-to-end computer vision pipeline for defect detection in manufacturing, achieving 94.2% precision on unseen test data

Mentored three junior data scientists and two analysts on statistical methods and production ML best practices, though still primarily hands-on with model development

Staff Data Scientist

Experian

Birmingham, United Kingdom

November 2022 - July 2023

Website: www.experian.co.uk

Developed and deployed five separate credit risk models using gradient boosting and ensemble methods, processing datasets with 50+ million records in PySpark

Established model governance framework and automated retraining pipelines using Airflow, reducing manual oversight by 85%

Owned end-to-end responsibility for a fraud detection system serving 2.3 million active users, collaborating with fraud operations and security teams

Led a cross-functional task force of 19 data engineers, analysts, and business stakeholders to implement new regulatory compliance requirements for model explainability

Junior Data Scientist

Speedy Logistics Solutions

Birmingham, United Kingdom

March 2021 - October 2022

Website: speedylogistics.co.uk

Built predictive models for vehicle route optimisation using genetic algorithms and reinforcement learning, reducing fuel costs by 12% across the fleet

Developed automated dashboards and reporting infrastructure using Tableau and Python, enabling real-time visibility into key performance metrics

Performed exploratory data analysis on GPS tracking data and delivery timestamps to identify efficiency patterns and anomalies

Cleaned and preprocessed datasets containing 8 million delivery records, implementing data validation pipelines to ensure quality standards

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2020

Grade: Upper Second Class Honours (2:1)

Final Year Project: Sentiment Analysis of Social Media Data Using Deep Learning (Grade: 78%)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Frameworks: Python, SQL, R, Scala, Java

Machine Learning: scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Keras, statsmodels

Data Engineering: Apache Spark, Airflow, Kafka, pandas, NumPy, Dask

Databases and Data Warehousing: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Snowflake, BigQuery, Redshift

Visualisation and BI Tools: Tableau, Power BI, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly

Cloud Platforms: AWS (SageMaker, EC2, S3), Google Cloud Platform (Dataflow, BigQuery), Azure (Machine Learning Studio)

Tools and Platforms: Jupyter Notebooks, Git, Docker, Kubernetes, Linux, Conda, MLflow

Statistical Methods: Regression, Classification, Time Series Forecasting, A/B Testing, Causal Inference, Bayesian Analysis

Specialisations: NLP, Computer Vision, Anomaly Detection, Credit Risk Modelling, Route Optimisation